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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU - BBA (HONOURS)

REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION APRIL 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Core Course (CC) – MG2CCRBBA100 – ORGANISATION BEHAVIOUR

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Part - A

Short Answer Questions (four to five sentences)

Each question carries 3 marks

1a. How OB principles can be applied to improve employee productivity? [U] / [CO1]

Ans: Organisational Behaviour helps managers understand employee behaviour, needs and motivation. Motivation techniques such as rewards, recognition and encouragement improve employee performance. Effective communication and teamwork increase coordination among employees. Training and supportive leadership also help employees work efficiently. A positive work environment improves job satisfaction and productivity.

OR

1b. List and describe the various types of organisational culture commonly observed in companies. [U] / [CO4]

Ans: Organisational culture refers to the shared values and practices followed in an organisation. Following are the different cultures that influence employee behaviour and organisational performance. (i) Clan culture focuses on teamwork, employee participation and involvement. (ii) Adhocracy culture encourages creativity, innovation and risk-taking. (iii) Market culture gives importance to competition, achieving targets and productivity. (iv) Hierarchy culture emphasizes rules, procedures, discipline and formal structure.

2a. Explain the nature of work group. [An] / [CO3]

Ans: A work group consists of two or more individuals working together to achieve common goals. Members interact regularly and depend on each other for completing tasks. Work groups can be formal or informal in nature. They help improve coordination, communication and problem solving in organisations. Group behaviour greatly influences employee performance and organisational effectiveness.

OR

2b. Explain the major developmental tasks of early adulthood. [A] / [CO2]

Ans: Early adulthood usually occurs between the ages of 20 and 40 years. During this stage, individuals focus on career development and achieving financial independence. Building relationships, marriage and family responsibilities are also important tasks. People develop emotional maturity and social adjustment during this period. Decision-making and achievement of life goals become major concerns.

3a. Analyse the theory that assumes employees are inherently lazy and need to be controlled. [An] / [CO2]

Ans: This assumption is explained in McGregor's Theory X. According to this theory, employees dislike work and avoid responsibility whenever possible. Managers following Theory X believe that workers require strict supervision and control. Motivation is mainly provided through punishment and monetary rewards. This theory results in an authoritarian style of management.

OR

3b. "People learn by observing others." Evaluate the statement. [An] / [CO2]

Ans: This statement is related to Albert Bandura's Social Learning Theory. According to the theory, individuals learn behaviour by observing and imitating others. Role models strongly influence attitudes and actions. Rewards and reinforcement encourage people to repeat learned behaviour. Observation is therefore an effective method of learning workplace skills and behaviour.

4a. Apply sociological concepts to suggest solutions for organisational issues. [U] / [CO1]

Ans: Sociology studies group behaviour and social relationships in organisations. Teamwork and cooperation can help reduce workplace conflicts. Proper communication improves coordination and understanding among employees. Knowledge of social roles helps managers assign responsibilities effectively. Organisational issues can therefore be solved through better group interaction, leadership and communication.

OR

4b. Illustrate personality. [U] / [CO2]

Ans: Personality refers to the unique characteristics and behaviour patterns of an individual. It influences how a person thinks, feels and behaves in different situations. Personality is shaped by heredity, environment and personal experiences. Traits such as confidence, honesty and friendliness form part of personality. Personality greatly affects employee behaviour and workplace relationships.

5a. Explain the different levels of conflict in an organisation with examples. [U] / [CO3]

Ans: Conflict in an organisation can occur at different levels. (i) Intrapersonal conflict occurs within an individual, such as stress in decision-making. (ii) Interpersonal conflict occurs between two individuals, such as disagreement between coworkers. (iii) Intragroup conflict takes place within a group when team members disagree. (iv) Intergroup conflict occurs between departments, such as conflicts between production and marketing departments. Conflict may positively or negatively affect organisational performance.

OR

5b. How does self-esteem become the reason for group formation? [E] / [CO3]

Ans: People often join groups to gain respect, recognition and acceptance from others. Group membership increases confidence and creates a sense of belongingness. Appreciation and support from group members improve self-esteem. Individuals feel emotionally secure when they are accepted by a group. Therefore, self-esteem becomes an important reason for group formation.

[5x3 = 15]

Part - B

Short Essay
Each question carries 5 marks.

6a. Explain how the attitude influences an employee's behaviour in the work environment. [A] / [CO2]

Ans: Attitude refers to a person's positive or negative feelings towards work, people or situations. Employee attitude strongly influences behaviour in the workplace. A positive attitude improves cooperation, productivity and job satisfaction. Employees with positive attitudes usually show commitment, punctuality and willingness to work. On the other hand, negative attitudes may lead to absenteeism, stress and low morale. Attitude also affects teamwork, communication and organisational culture. Managers can improve employee attitudes through motivation, support and good leadership.

OR

6b. A US-based multinational company has acquired a Japanese company and wants to introduce its popular burger brand. What cross-cultural challenges will the company face in the introduction of new burger brand? [An] / [CO4]

Ans: The company may face several cross-cultural challenges while introducing its burger brand in Japan. Cultural differences in food habits may affect customer acceptance because Japanese consumers may prefer traditional food items. Language barriers can create

communication problems in marketing and management. Differences in management style and work culture may also affect employees. American culture is more individualistic, while Japanese culture gives importance to teamwork and group harmony. Advertising methods accepted in the US may not be suitable in Japanese culture. Therefore, the company must adapt its products and strategies according to local cultural values and preferences.

7a. Illustrate different learning theories in OB. [An] / [CO2]

Ans: Learning theories explain how individuals acquire knowledge and behaviour in organisations. (i) Classical Conditioning Theory states that learning occurs through association between stimulus and response. (ii) Operant Conditioning Theory explains that behaviour is shaped through rewards and punishments. (iii) Social Learning Theory states that people learn by observing and imitating others. (iv) Cognitive Learning Theory emphasizes learning through thinking, understanding and problem solving. These learning theories help managers understand employee behaviour, training and motivation.

OR

7b. How do situation-related factors help to shape perception? Give example. [U] / [CO2]

Ans: Perception is influenced not only by individuals but also by situational factors. Time, work environment and social setting affect how people interpret situations. Stressful situations may create negative perceptions and misunderstandings. For example, an employee may perceive a manager's strict behaviour differently during a crisis situation. Organisational culture and workplace atmosphere also influence perception. Therefore, situational factors play an important role in shaping employee perception and behaviour.

8a. Categorize different types of conflict within an organization and apply them to specific workplace situations with examples. [A] / [CO3]

Ans: Conflict within an organisation can be classified into different types. (i) Intrapersonal conflict occurs within an individual, such as confusion between work and family responsibilities. (ii) Interpersonal conflict occurs between individuals, such as disagreement between a manager and an employee. (iii) Intragroup conflict occurs among members of the same group, such as differences of opinion in a project team. (iv) Intergroup conflict occurs between departments, such as disputes between the sales and production departments. Though conflict may create stress, proper communication and teamwork can help manage conflicts effectively.

OR

8b. Interpret the concept of situational leadership in the situational leadership theory. [U] / [CO4]

Ans: Situational Leadership Theory was developed by Hersey and Blanchard. The theory states that no single leadership style is suitable for all situations. Leaders must change their style according to the ability and willingness of employees. Different leadership styles include directing, coaching, supporting and delegating. Employees with less experience require more guidance, while skilled employees require less supervision. Situational leadership improves employee performance, flexibility and organisational effectiveness.

[3×5 = 15]

Part - C

Long Essay

Each question carries 20 marks.

9a. A marketing company wants to hire a creative team member. Which Big Five personality trait should they prioritize during hiring? [A] / [CO2]

Ans: The Big Five Personality Model includes openness to experience, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness and emotional stability. For a creative marketing role, the company should prioritize **openness to experience**.

- Openness refers to creativity, imagination, curiosity and willingness to try new ideas.
- Individuals with high openness are innovative and flexible in thinking.
- They contribute fresh ideas in advertising, branding and promotion.
- Such employees can understand changing customer preferences and solve problems creatively.
- Creativity is important in marketing for attracting customers through innovative strategies.
- Other traits like conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness and emotional stability are also important.
- However, openness to experience is most suitable for creative marketing roles because it encourages innovation, adaptability and original thinking.

OR

9b. Describe the key principles of effective goal setting and explain how goals influence motivation and behaviour. [U] / [CO2]

Ans: Goal setting refers to establishing targets that guide employee efforts and behaviour. According to Locke's Goal Setting Theory, clear and challenging goals improve motivation and performance.

Principles of Effective Goal Setting

- Clarity – Goals should be specific and understandable.
- Challenge – Goals should be difficult but achievable.
- Commitment – Employees should be willing to achieve goals.
- Feedback – Regular feedback improves performance.
- Task Complexity – Difficult tasks require planning and support.

Influence on Motivation and Behaviour

- Goals provide direction and purpose.
- Challenging goals increase effort and persistence.
- Employees become more focused and disciplined.
- Goal achievement improves confidence and job satisfaction.
- Goals improve teamwork, coordination and productivity.
- Rewards and recognition encourage positive behaviour.

Thus, effective goal setting improves employee motivation, behaviour and organisational performance.

10a. Apply your understanding of individual and situational factors to explain how perception affects the performance. [U] / [CO2]

Ans: Perception is the process through which individuals interpret information from their environment. It influences employee behaviour and performance.

Individual Factors

- Attitude influences positive or negative perception.
- Personality affects interpretation of situations.
- Motivation helps employees view challenges positively.
- Past experience shapes judgement and understanding.

Situational Factors

- Work environment affects employee perception.
- Stress and time pressure may create misunderstandings.
- Social setting and group influence affect perception.
- Organisational culture also shapes employee views.

Effect on Performance

- Positive perception improves productivity and teamwork.
- Employees feel motivated when treated fairly.
- Negative perception creates stress and conflicts.
- Incorrect perception reduces efficiency and communication.

For example, supportive feedback may improve performance, while criticism may demotivate employees. Thus, perception significantly affects organisational performance.

OR

10b. Evaluate a real-life scenario of self-leadership and explain how self-awareness, proactivity and resilience help an individual in overcoming challenges and achieve goals. [A] / [CO4]

Ans: Self-leadership refers to the ability to guide and motivate oneself to achieve goals. It helps individuals remain focused and confident during challenges.

Real-Life Scenario

- A student preparing for competitive examinations while managing financial and family difficulties shows self-leadership.
- The student follows a study schedule and remains committed to long-term goals.

Role of Self-Awareness

- Helps individuals understand strengths and weaknesses.
- Improves decision-making and self-improvement.
- The student identifies weak subjects and works harder on them.

Role of Proactivity

- Encourages planning and taking initiative.
- The student manages study time and prepares in advance.
- Helps achieve goals systematically.

Role of Resilience

- Helps overcome failures and stress.
- Encourages determination and continued effort despite setbacks.
- Builds emotional strength and persistence.

Thus, self-awareness, proactivity and resilience help individuals overcome challenges and achieve success.

[2×20 = 40]

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